country', *The Telegraph*, 14 February 1991; and his interview to A. Surya Prakash, 'Advani trains guns on "pseudo-secularists"', *The Indian Express*, 4 February 1991. Advani's successor as BJP president, Murali Manohar Joshi, made the same argument in an interview to Rajiv Saxena, 'The Hindu majority makes india secular', *Observer*, 13 January 1991. Atal Bihari Vajpayee in 1991 also argued that the Ayodhya issue 'is not a religious issue. It's a national issue in the sense that Ram is a national hero.' See his interview to Vinod Sharma, 'There are elements who want the BJP to become a religious party', *Hindustan Times*, 10 February 1991.

8. Yogi Adityanath's interview to *Network 18* at India Summit, 17 March 2018. Full video available at: https://www.news18.com/news/politics/nobody-is-more-secular-than-hindus-says-yogi-adityanath-at-news-18-rising-india-summit-1692553.html. Yogi's usage of the word 'panth' echoed a sentiment first articulated by the then BJP Union home minister, Rajnath Singh, in a 2015 speech in Parliament during a ceremony to commemorate the Constitution and its framer Dr B.R. Ambedkar. Singh argued that 'The official translation of the word "secularism" is *panth-nirpeksh* [sect neutral], not *dharm-nirpeksh* [religion-neutral]. Bharat's dharam in itself is *panth-nirpkesh*.' He was referring to the fact that the official translation of India's Constitution in Hindi translates the word 'secularism' as 'panth-nirpeksh'. This ignited a wider debate on secularism and its meaning and the BJP's political intentions at the time, with Congress leaders accusing the BJP of 'playing games' with the meaning of the term. Clips of Rajnath Singh's speech on 26 November 2015 available at https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=CPNiLB9jXr8&t=2s. Full text of the official Hindi translation of India's Constitution is available at https://legislative.gov.in/hi/constitution-of-india.
9. In multipolar election contests in the first-past-the-post system, the effective number of political parties/players increases. Bipolarity represents a two-way concentration of votes. The minimal level of a multipolar configuration would be a three-way contest. In states like UP, it could be even higher. While there are often a large